

VER. 26.1

Authenticity

Eye Bars

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1. Implementation

The document has been created and approved by the General Assembly of 09.11.2024.
The document and its rules have been implemented since the 2025 season.

2. Definition and Description

2.1. Definition

"**Eye bars**" are the term used to describe additional protection for the eye slots of a helmet.

Rare historical sources display some additional eye protection, mainly for great helms.

However, it is permitted to add Eye bars that do not rely on historical sources to increase the safety of helmets. The number and type of permitted Eye bars are displayed in each helmet rules document.

2.2. Eye bars Description

Eye bars can be:

- **Externally Riveted Eye bars**
  This type of Eye bars is documented by historical sources for specific helmets. Therefore, they are only allowed on helmet models that can be historically referenced to have externally riveted Eye bars. If there is no supporting evidence for a particular helmet style, externally riveted Eye bars are not permitted on that helmet.

- **Integrated Eye bars**
  This type of Eye bars is documented by historical sources for certain helmets as part of the visor or faceplate itself. They are only permitted on helmet models that can be shown to have used integrated Eye bars historically. If no suitable source exists, integrated Eye bars are not allowed. They must closely replicate the shape, placement, and size seen in surviving artifacts or credible period art.

- **Safety Eye bars**
  This type of Eye bar is **not documented by historical sources.** These concealed Eye bars are allowed solely to increase safety in modern buhurt combat. They typically consist of metal bars riveted or welded to the **inside** of a helmet, thus remaining concealed from the outside.

  Number and Placement of Safety Eye bars:

  - For helmets with **two separate Eye slots**, you may install **up to two (2) vertical Eye bars per Eye slot.**
  - For helmets with **one continuous Eye slot**, you may install **up to five (5) Eye bars** across the slot.

3. General Requirements

All types of Eye bars must respect the following requirements:

- Be firmly attached to prevent any breakage and maintain a high level of protection in any situation.
- Protect the whole Eye slot from top to bottom.

Recommended: Eye slots should not exceed an opening of 25 mm



4. Externally Riveted Eye bars

4.1. Historical Sources and Datation

A few historical sources display this type of Eye bar.
The main source is the Great Helm from Nuremberg (1350).



Despite its rarity, it is **Approved** for **14th century**, **Transitional** and **15th century armors**.

4.2. Specific Requirements

Externally riveted Eye bars must:

- conform with the General Requirements (see Section 3 above),
- be firmly riveted to the outside of the Eye slot,
- resemble the historical sources and not exceed a width of 30mm,
- be made of metal.

4.3. Examples of Approved Reproductions



Picture by Zoom en Lice ©

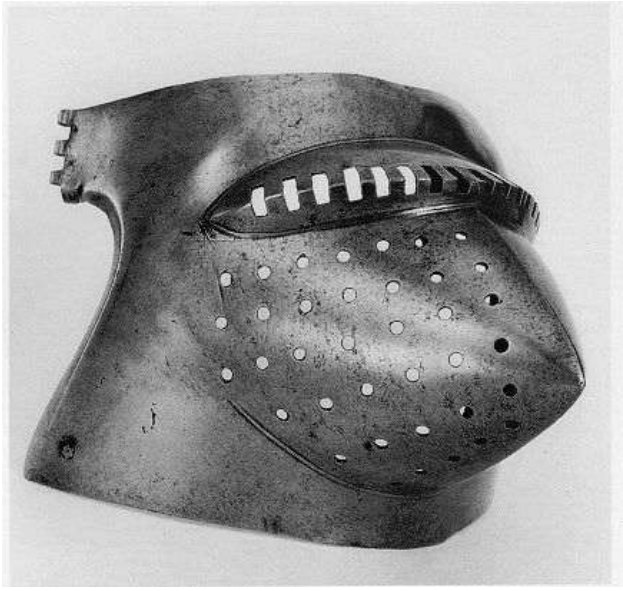
5. Integrated Eye bars

5.1. Historical Sources and Datation

A few historical sources display this type of Eye bar. One artifact from the Churburg castle shows a nice example. .



1380 BNF Nouvelle acquisition française Paris France
Integrated eyebar for side-pivoting visored bascinet



1390-1410 - Churburg - Italy

5.2. Specific Requirements

Integrated Eye bars must:

- conform with the general requirements (see Section 3 above),
- be sturdy made and able to endure full-contact fights,
- resemble the historical sources and not exceed a width of 20mm.

5.3. Examples of Approved Reproductions



Picture from Master Uley ©

6. Safety Eye bars

6.1. Historical Sources and Datation

There are no historical sources for Eye bars welded onto Eye slots.

Nevertheless, for safety reasons, they are **Approved** for **14th century**, **Transitional** and **15th century armors.**

6.2. Specific Requirements

Safety Eye bars must:

- conform with the General Requirements (see Section 3 above),
- be welded or riveted from the inside of the helm,
- be sturdy made and able to endure full-contact fights,
- be painted black.

6.3. Examples of Approved Reproductions







Pictures from The Medieval Things ©

6.4. Examples of Denied Reproductions

Too many eyebars



Picture from The Medieval Things ©

7. Changelog

Below, we will keep track of all the changes made over the lifetime of this document. This way, all our members can see how the documents are changing over time.

January - 2026 (V. 26.1)
Formatting redone for consistency and legibility. Except points listed below, no content changes.
Replace:
Throughout the document "Buhurt "Optimized" Eye bars" by "Safety Eye bars"

Add: "1. Implementation" (and subsequent modification of all Title numbers in the document)
Clarification:
- Split of "1. Definition and general requirements" in "2. Definition and description" and "3. General Requirements". **This split doesn't have an impact on the content of the rules.**

Add:
- 2.2 Eye bars description: whole paragraph on Integrated Eye bars and multiple precisions on Externally riveted Eye bars and Safety Eye bars

Add: "5. Integrated Eye bars" (and subsequent modification of all Title numbers in the document)
Replace:
- In 5.1 Historical Sources and Datation: "The main source is the Great Helm from Nuremberg (1350)." by "One artifact from the Churburg castle shows a nice example."
-
- In 6.4 Examples of Denied Reproductions: "Too much eyebars" by "too many Eye bars"

December-2024: -add
Document has been created